

Chapter 2

Image Processing Basics

What will we learn?

- How is a digital image represented and stored in memory?
- What are the main types of digital image representation?
- What are the most popular image file formats?
- What are the most common types of image processing operations and how do they affect pixel values?

Digital Image Representation

$$f(x, y) = \begin{bmatrix} f(0, 0) & f(0, 1) & \cdots & f(0, N-1) \\ f(1, 0) & f(1, 1) & \cdots & f(1, N-1) \\ \vdots & \vdots & & \vdots \\ f(M-1, 0) & f(M-1, 1) & \cdots & f(M-1, N-1) \end{bmatrix}$$

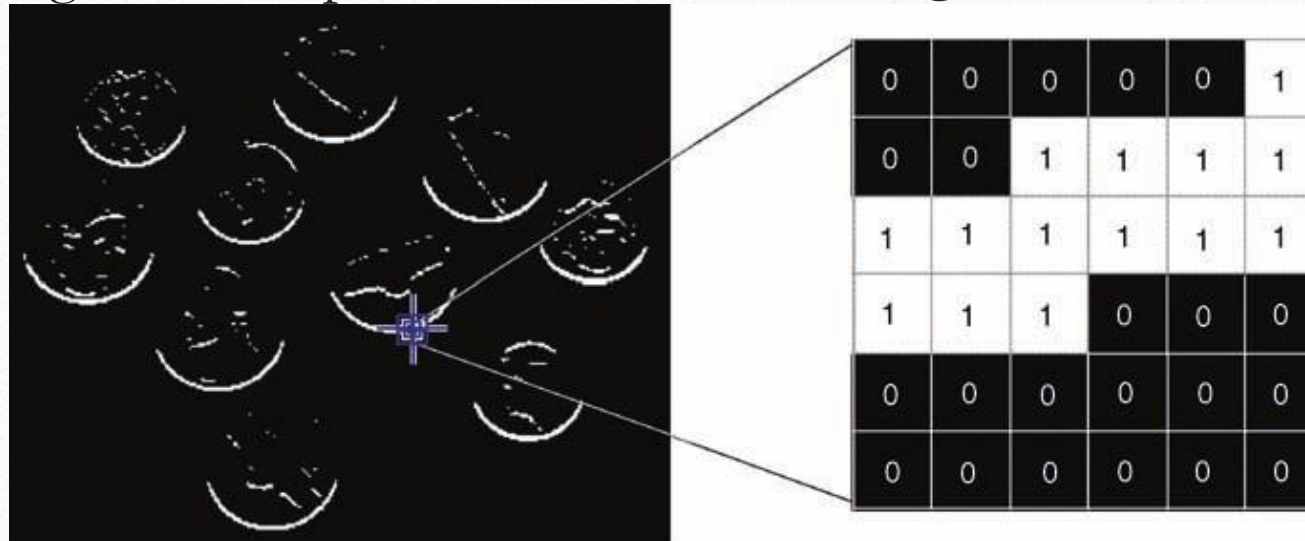
$$f(p, q) = \begin{bmatrix} f(1, 1) & f(1, 2) & \cdots & f(1, N) \\ f(2, 1) & f(2, 2) & \cdots & f(2, N) \\ \vdots & \vdots & & \vdots \\ f(M, 1) & f(M, 2) & \cdots & f(M, N) \end{bmatrix}$$

Raster vs Vector

- Raster (or bitmap) image format = one or more 2D arrays of pixels
 - Good quality and fast display speed but larger memory storage requirement and size dependency
- Vector image format = series of drawing commands
 - Resizing without introducing artifact, less size but need to be rasterized for display devices

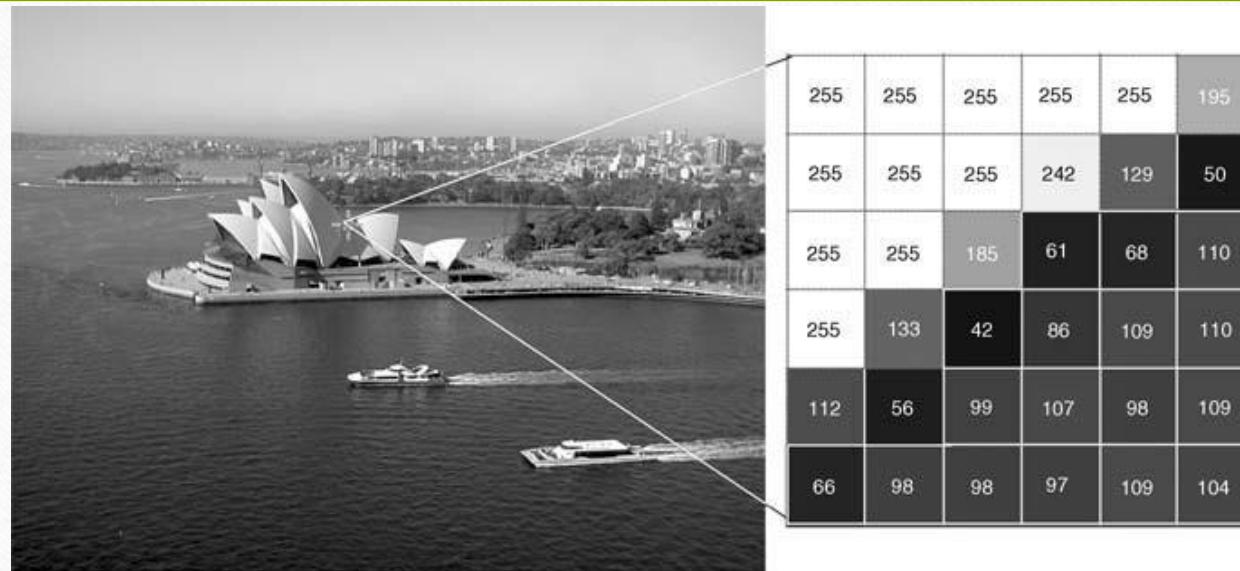
Example

- A binary image and the pixel values in a 6×6 neighborhood



- In Matlab it is called *logical* array of 0's and 1's

A gray-level image and the pixel values in a 6×6 neighborhood



Gray-level, monochrome, grayscale In Matlab most popular are **uint8** (0=black, 255=white), **uint16** (0=black, 65535=white), **double** (0.0=black, 1.0=white)

Color Images

- RGB, a 24-bit number 8bits for each of RED, GREEN and BLUE
- Indexed representation. A pixel contains an index to the palette of colors...

Color Image, R, G and B



(a)



(b)

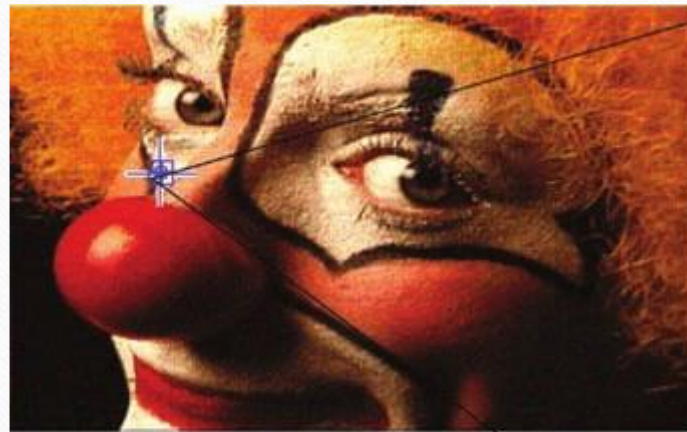


(c)



(d)

Indexed Image...



<73> R:1.00 G:0.70 B:0.58	<80> R:1.00 G:1.00 B:0.87	<80> R:1.00 G:1.00 B:0.87	<80> R:1.00 G:1.00 B:0.87
<73> R:1.00 G:0.70 B:0.58	<80> R:1.00 G:1.00 B:0.87	<77> R:1.00 G:0.87 B:0.70	<80> R:1.00 G:1.00 B:0.87
<37> R:0.58 G:0.41 B:0.29	<77> R:1.00 G:0.87 B:0.70	<80> R:1.00 G:1.00 B:0.87	<80> R:1.00 G:1.00 B:0.87
<22> R:0.41 G:0.29 B:0.12	<80> R:1.00 G:1.00 B:0.87	<77> R:1.00 G:0.87 B:0.70	<80> R:1.00 G:1.00 B:0.87

Some Image File Formats

- Lossy vs Lossless Compression

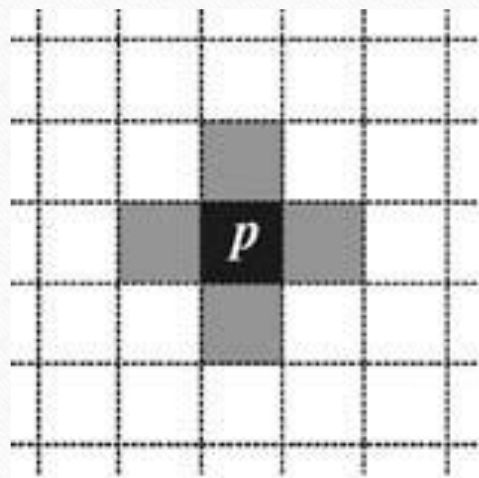
- BIN, PPM (PBM,PGM, PNM) – raw pixel data
Need to know all sizes, bytes per pixel etc
- BMP – Microsoft Windows
- JPEG – most popular for photographic quality images

- GIF – uses indexed representation of colors with maximum of 256 colors palette
- TIFF – 24bit per pixel (truecolor), 5 different compression schemes
- PNG – supports both indexed and truecolor format, patent free replacement for GIF
- RAW – adopted by camera manufacturers

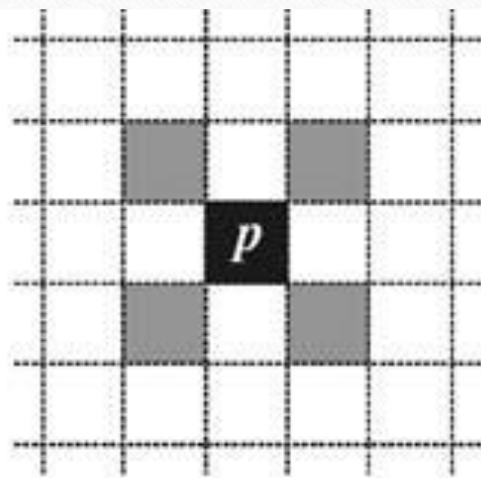
Basic Terminology

- **Image Topology.** It involves the investigation of fundamental image properties, such as number of a particular object, number of separate (not connected) regions, and number of holes in an object etc.
- **Neighborhood.** The pixels surrounding a given pixel constitute its neighborhood, which can be interpreted as a smaller matrix containing (and usually centered around) the reference pixel.

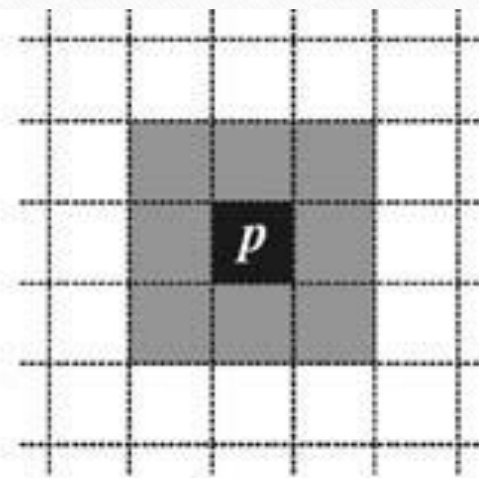
(a) 4-neighborhood, (b) diagonal neighborhood, (c) 8-neighborhood



(a)



(b)



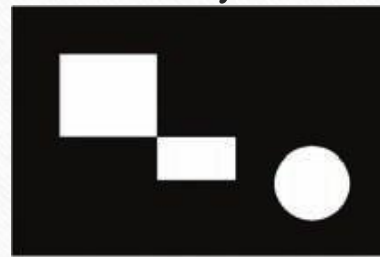
(c)

Basic Terminology (cont.)

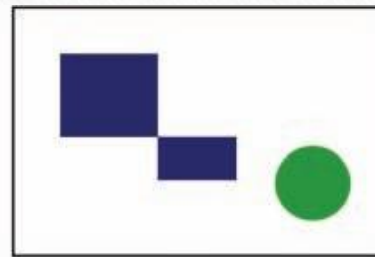
- **Adjacency:** 2 pixel p and q are 4-adjacent if they are 4-neighbors of each other
- 8-adjacency – similar.
- **Paths.** A 4-path between two pixels p and q is a sequence of pixels starting with p and ending with q such that each pixel in the sequence is 4-adjacent to its predecessor in the sequence.
- 8-path – similar.

Basic Terminology (cont.)

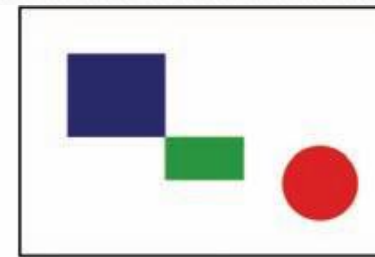
- **Connectivity.** If there is a 4-path between pixels p and q , they are said to be 4-connected
- 8-connected
- **Components.** A set of pixels that are connected to each other is called a component. (a) original (binary) image (b) results for 8-connectivity (c) results for 4-connectivity.



(a)



(b)



(c)

Basic Terminology (cont.)

- **Distances Between Pixels**

- Euclidean distance:

$$D_e(p, q) = \sqrt{(x_1 - x_0)^2 + (y_1 - y_0)^2}$$

- D_4 (also known as *Manhattan* or *city block*) distance:

$$D_4(p, q) = |x_1 - x_0| + |y_1 - y_0|$$

- D_8 (also known as *chessboard*) distance:

$$D_8(p, q) = \max(|x_1 - x_0|, |y_1 - y_0|)$$

Image Processing Operations

- Operations in the Spatial Domain
 - Global (Point) Operations
 - Neighborhood-Oriented Operations
 - Operations Combining Multiple Images
- Operations in a Transform Domain
 - Fourier Transform
 - Discrete Cosine Transform

Intensity reduction by 2 (global operation)

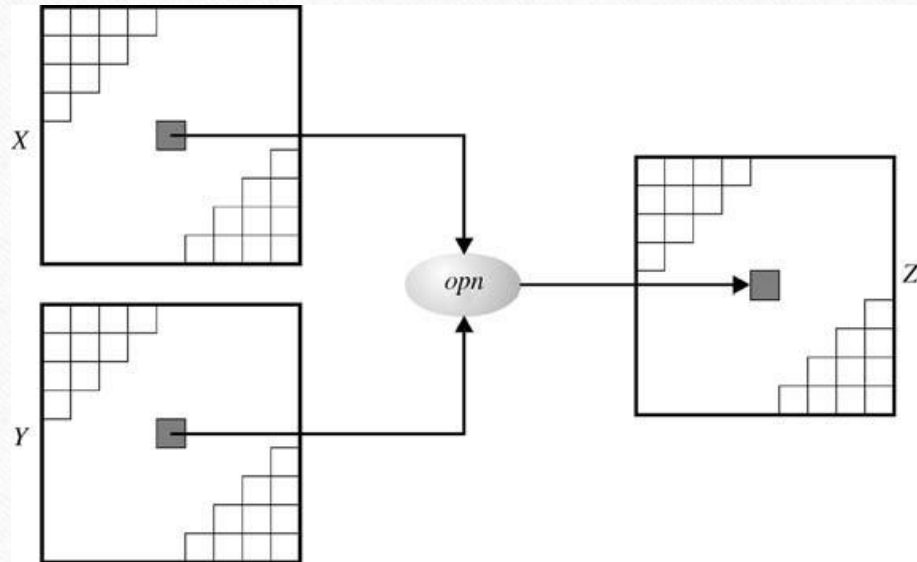


(a)

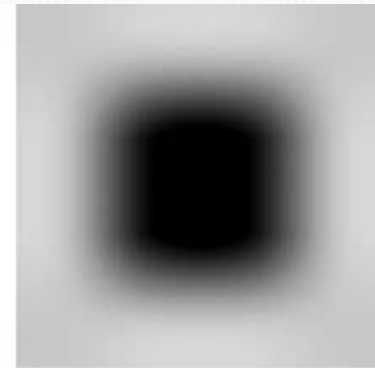


(b)

Combining Two Images



(a)



(b)

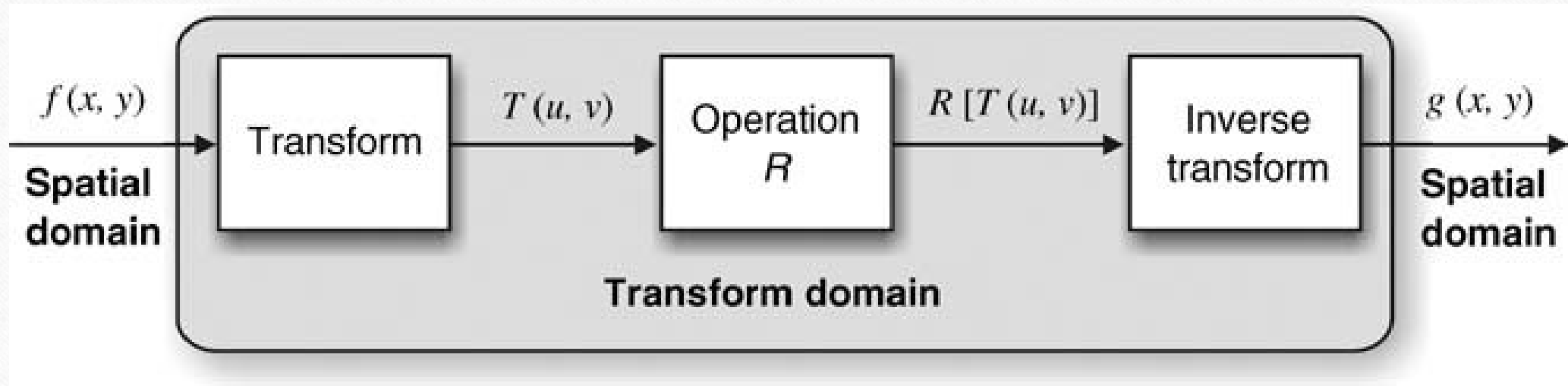


(c)

Sharpening an image by neighborhood operation



Operations in Transform Domain



References

- Practical Image and Video Processing using Matlab, Oge Marques, 2011,
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